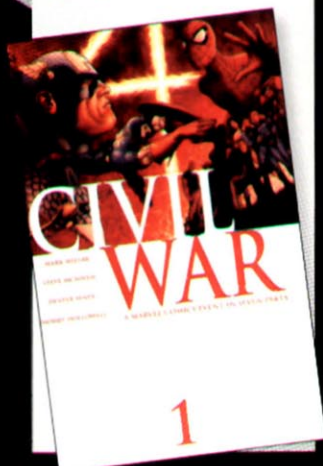


CIVIL WAR

The Battle Between Heroes

ISSUE #1

When the New Warriors try to capture Nitro, he explodes, killing several hundred people. The government response splits the remaining Super Heroes into a Civil War.



Spider-Man complied with the law, at the urging of Iron Man, and revealed his secret identity to a shocked world.

Having reinvented themselves as the heroes of a reality TV show, the **NEW WARRIORS** moved in on a house containing four Super Villains: Cobalt Man, Coldheart, **NITRO**, and **SPEEDFREAK**. During the ensuing battle, Nitro exploded in the middle of Stamford, Connecticut. The blast killed over six hundred people, including Microbe, Namorita, and Night Thrasher.

REGISTER OR ELSE

The public outcry over the tragedy spurred Congress to pass the Superhuman Registration Act, which required all superpowered people in the US to register with the government—and work for it as part of **SHIELD**—or face imprisonment. In the wake of M-Day, the public had already been pushing for such safeguards, and the Stamford disaster gave it the impetus it needed to get through.

The new law split the Super Hero community in two. Many of the heroes understood the need for the law and planned to comply with it. Others believed it to be a bad law and planned to fight it.

IRON MAN, **MR. FANTASTIC**, and **Hank Pym** led those who backed the law, while **CAPTAIN AMERICA** refused to help **SHIELD** and went underground to form a secret Avengers as the core of his resistance movement. As soon as the law went into effect and **SHIELD** starting rounding up outlaw heroes, the resistance set to freeing them.

Notably, most of the backers of the law already had public identities to begin with, while many of those who protested the law did not. The most famous exception was **SPIDER-MAN**, who sided with his mentor **IRON MAN**. After some soul searching, he revealed his secret identity as Peter Parker at a globally televised press conference.

The **X-MEN** officially declared neutrality during the conflict, which soon became known as the Civil War. Although they sympathized with the resistance, they had been nearly destroyed on M-Day and did not wish to risk making their eradication complete.

In the first major conflict between the two sides, **SHIELD** unleashed a clone of **THOR**. The clone killed **GIANT-MAN** (Bill Foster) and would have harmed others had the **INVISIBLE WOMAN** not switched sides to protect the resistance. The incident caused heroes on both sides to reconsider their choices. Spider-Man switched to Captain America's team, while **NIGHTHAWK** and **STATURE** decided to register.

Desperate to even the sides, Captain America and his heroes launched an attack on the super-prison Mr. Fantastic had built in the Negative Zone. Anticipating this, Iron Man led a team to stop them. **CLOAK** teleported the entire battle back to Manhattan, and the resistance was winning handily when a group of firefighters, EMTs, and police tackled Captain America to keep him from killing Iron Man.

Looking around at the damage the battle had caused, Captain America realized that his team had won "everything except the argument." He surrendered himself to the NYPD, effectively ending the conflict. In the aftermath, Iron Man became the new director of **SHIELD** and launched the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118-9). *MF*

At a turning point in the war, a clone of Thor slew Bill Foster, the latest Giant-Man.



After Namorita slammed him into a school bus outside of a playground, Nitro exploded and killed over 600 innocents—including dozens of children—rather than be captured and thrown into jail. This atrocity spurred the passage of the Superhuman Registration Act that launched the Civil War.



The Baxter Building served as a rallying point after the initial tragedy. With Congress about to pass the Superhuman Registration Act, the greatest heroes of the age assembled there to discuss how they should respond.



Villains were promised a measure of amnesty if they would register with the government and help Iron Man track down and capture the outlaw heroes.